

Strengths

UP Warriorz retained its core by holding on to Shweta Sehrawat and exercising RTMs on Deepti Sharma, Sophie Ecclestone, Kiran Navgire and Kranti Gaud.

The squad has been further strengthened by elite overseas experience in Meg Lanning, Phoebe Litchfield, Deandra Dottin and Chloe Tryon, adding leadership, power and versatility. Young prospects such as G. Trisha and Shipra Giri add depth, while Shikha Pandey's inclusion bolsters the pace attack. A returning Asha Sobhana further enhances an already strong spin group. On paper, this is UP Warriorz's most well-rounded squad to date.

Weaknesses

Despite the upgrades, questions remain. Batting instability hurt the Warriorz last season, with constant changes disrupting rhythm and partnerships. While the personnel now look stronger, clarity around roles at the top and middle order will be critical.

Selection balance could also prove tricky given the number of overseas match-winners, while the wicketkeeper-batter slot remains unresolved, with uncapped Shipra the only specialist option. Leadership is another subplot. Whether Deepti continues at the helm or Lanning is handed the reins could influence the side's identity through the season.

Player to watch: Kranti Gaud

Kranti returns as a far more established figure after a breakthrough WPL 2025. Her four-wicket haul on debut against Delhi Capitals marked her arrival, and strong performances soon earned her an international call-up.

Now a regular in India's setup, the 22-year-old pacer offers early strikes with the new ball through sharp bouncers and accurate yorkers, along with useful lower-order hitting.

Full Squad

Shweta Sehrawat, Deepti Sharma, Sophie Ecclestone, Meg Lanning, Phoebe Litchfield, Kiran Navgire, Harleen Deol, Kranti Goud, Asha Sobhana, Deandra Dottin, Shikha Pandey, Shipra Giri, Simran Shaikh, Charli Knott, Chloe Tryon, Suman Meena, G. Trisha, Pratika Rawal

Kranti Gaud

PTI

UP Warriorz